

An aerial photograph of a public square with a grey stone plaza and a lighter-colored tiled area. A large, semi-transparent circle is overlaid on the left side of the image. Several groups of people are visible, some sitting on a set of stairs and others walking or standing in the plaza. The overall scene is a busy public space.

GREEN FINANCING FRAMEWORK

March 2025



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1.

INTRODUCTION

1.1 BUSINESS OVERVIEW

Veolia Environnement Group (“**Veolia**” or the “Group”) is a world leader in environmental services and offers a complete range of solutions for managing Water, Waste and Energy on five continents.

Veolia, headquartered in France, is listed on Euronext Paris and included in the CAC 40 index.

Veolia has three main business lines (Water, Waste and Energy) and operates in two key markets (the municipal market and the industrial market, which includes the service sector). It is involved in the entire value chain of water (supply of drinkable water, wastewater treatment), waste management (collection, processing and energy/material recovery) and energy services (supply of heating and cooling services or the optimization of industrial processes).

Veolia’s organization is divided into seven geographic zones (France and Special Waste Europe, Central and Eastern Europe, Northern Europe, Asia Pacific, Iberia and Latin America, North America, Italy and Africa-Middle East) and an additional worldwide zone (Water technologies). In the geographic zones, the organization is structured by delegated zone or country (Business Unit), with the directors for each country responsible for the Water, Waste and Energy business lines within their scope.



1.2 VEOLIA'S PURPOSE AND SUSTAINABILITY STRATEGY

Veolia was one of the first French groups to define its purpose (*"sa raison d'être"*), adopted by its Board of Directors in April 2019. The Group's purpose was drawn up in consultation with its various stakeholders and approved by the Board of Directors, and articulates why Veolia exists and what it does and how, for the benefit of all its stakeholders. This purpose, which is the fruit of more than 170 years of history, is in line with Veolia's "Resourcing the World" mission statement.

Ecological transformation, that is our purpose:

"Ecological transformation means acting to reconcile human progress and environmental protection. We develop and implement locally solutions to depollute our vital resources and preserve them from depletion, solutions to decarbonize our ways of living and producing and adapt them to the consequences of climate change. All over the world, attuned to local cultures, we strive to improve the health and quality of life of communities."

At Veolia, we tackle economic, social and environmental issues as an inseparable whole to the benefit of the largest number of people."



The long version of the purpose can be found on Veolia's website (www.veolia.com).

Veolia's 2024-2027 Strategic program: **GreenUp**

2023 was the final year of the Impact 2023 program, during which Veolia demonstrated its ability to achieve its financial and non-financial performance targets through its agility, operational excellence and financial discipline.

In 2024, Veolia launched its new GreenUp strategic program for the period 2024-2027.

For Veolia, ecological transformation requires solutions which decarbonize, depollute and regenerate and therefore preserve health, well-being and purchasing power, the strategic autonomy and attractiveness of territories and the performance of industrial customers. This impact demonstrates the importance of dedicating efforts to greening transformation, and not just to what is already "green": this is precisely the objective of GreenUp.

GreenUp presents a value creation model that combines our three strongholds and three boosters to accelerate our profitable growth:

- **Essential services strongholds in the infrastructure model:** Municipal water, Solid waste and District heating. These businesses provide essential services under long-term contracts with strong visibility of cash flow generation and will have solid growth in the coming years.
- **Growth boosters**, rooted in our bastions, will drive our growth:
 - in the energy business segment, bioenergy, renewable energy, flexibility and energy efficiency;
 - in water technologies and new solutions; and
 - hazardous waste treatment.

With **GreenUp**, Veolia confirms its ambition to **combine activity growth while accelerating its ecological transformation impact** with these three growth boosters and objectives for 2027:

Booster 1.

DECARBONIZING LOCAL ENERGY

The first booster of the GreenUp program involves bioenergy, energy efficiency in buildings and industries, and flexibility. Veolia's commitment is to produce local, low-carbon energy for all its municipal and industrial customers worldwide through the production of 8 GW of bioenergy and a flexible installed capacity of 3 GW by 2030. From the production of bioenergy from non-recyclable waste and wastewater to heat and cold recovery, energy efficiency solutions and CO₂ capture, the Group is focusing on a **increase by 30% of the CO₂ erased (scope 4) between 2023 and 2027.**

Booster 2.

NEW WATER SOLUTIONS TO SAVE AND RECYCLE THIS PRECIOUS RESOURCE

Water technologies and new solutions are the program's second booster. They will preserve and regenerate resources by **reducing Veolia's footprint on drinking water resources abstracted by over 1.5 million m³ by 2027.** Veolia aims to become the water services provider of the future by focusing on the efficiency of its solutions, such as the reuse of treated wastewater, the treatment of water and pollutants, including micro-pollutants using cutting-edge technologies, or the production of drinking water.

Booster 3.

HAZARDOUS WASTE TREATMENT, TO DEPOLLUTE, IMPROVE HEALTH AND PROTECT BIODIVERSITY

Hazardous waste treatment is the third booster in this program with the objective **to combat pollution and preserve the health of populations, by processing 9 million metric tons of hazardous waste**. This will process the most toxic and harmful components to preserve the health of individuals and ecosystems. The Group intends to accelerate circular economy solutions and innovation in lithium battery recycling, with the construction of several facilities, including one in Europe for copper, cobalt, nickel and lithium refining.

In addition to these objectives, Veolia is **also accelerating its own decarbonization trajectory**, for both its own operations and the assets of its customers.

In accordance with the Paris agreements, Veolia undertakes to:

- reduce its scope 1 & 2 emissions by 50% by 2032 while stepping up its investments mainly to phase-out coal in Europe and capture biogas in landfills;
- increase scope 4 erased emissions by 50% by 2030;
- achieve Net Zero in 2050.

This accelerated plan was approved by the **Science Based Targets Initiative (SBTi) in July 2024**.

Veolia will achieve this reduction in emissions by:

- reducing the emissions of its Energy activities by phasing out the use of coal in Europe (investment plan of €1.6 billion between 2018 and 2030), while relying more on green energies and capitalizing on its expertise in energy efficiency;
- reducing the emissions of its Waste activities mainly by capturing biogas, using low-emission vehicles and removing plastics in its waste-to-energy facilities;
- the Water activity will also contribute by increasing the use of green energies.



1.3 STAKEHOLDER RELATIONS & MULTIFACETED PERFORMANCE

The Group's relations with its stakeholder are at the core of Veolia's Purpose.

A member of the Executive Committee was tasked specifically with stakeholder issues. The aim is to find an innovative approach to Group relations with stakeholders and support Group Business Units in this area, as well as to strengthen the relationship of trust and cooperation with stakeholders.

The need for a close relationship with public authorities, civil society, international organizations, multi-stakeholder platforms, local communities and consumers creates an opportunity for the Group to ascertain their expectations, establish itself locally in the long-term and create innovative solutions together with different partners. Having an exceptional relationship with its stakeholders enables better adaptation to change, and faced with the growing expectations of civil society and regulations, Veolia must be a regional player in solidarity with others to facilitate the roll-out of solutions to implement ecological transformation.

Veolia conducts discussion with its stakeholders through various forums, dialogue with labor and management, cooperation with academic, scientific and technical partners, meetings with high-level experts, participation in working groups, conferences and international events, and also in particular:

- **The Critical Friends Committee**, created in 2013, is today made up of around a dozen independent people, experts in human resources and social and environmental issues, from institutions, the academic community and non-profit organizations and company partners, including a representative of young climate activists. This collective forum of discussion provides Veolia Executive Management with an external viewpoint on strategic topics in relation to its corporate responsibility, in order to foster and support the Group's initiative to make continuous progress.

- **The “+1, ecology turned into action” consultation process** is a pilot process launched by Veolia in 2021, in partnership with bluenove (the expert agency for collective intelligence methods), the forward-looking media Usbek & Rica and La REcyclerie de Paris, with the support of Comité 21. This consultation process brings together 50 representatives of Veolia stakeholders (employees, customers, stakeholders, society, planet) to work together seamlessly, with no barriers. This is a way of amplifying cooperation and ideas to create more concerted solutions for ecological transformation. The +1 method was adopted for Veolia's corporate strategy to prepare Veolia's 2024-2027 strategic program.

- **The “+1 Inspire 24-27” consultation promoted an open dialogue with the Group's stakeholders:** a committee comprising representatives of employees, customers, shareholders, society and the planet was set up in each of the Group's 8 zones, at Business Unit level (Australia / New Zealand, Colombia, the United States, France, Italy, Japan, Czech Republic and Japan).

These 8 committees contributed to discussions to develop the next strategic program through three complementary work sessions applicable to different contexts and issues (contracts, projects, Business Units, etc.). At the end of the consultation, the analysis of the responses resulted in a summary shared with the Group's top management.

- **The Veolia Institute** looks to the future and considers challenges relating to both the environment and society. It develops its activities through ongoing dialogue in economic and intellectual circles and with practitioners that lead their field in the areas it studies. Through conferences, a review (Institute Review – FACTS reports) and forward-looking working groups, the Veolia Institute brings together and circulates the experience and expertise of different players (researchers, academic experts, public powers, companies, NGOs, international organizations, etc.) to gain different viewpoints on certain major planetary issues and shed light on the future.

Veolia uses various tools for listening to and collecting Veolia's stakeholders expectations, in particular:

ECOLOGICAL TRANSFORMATION BAROMETER

In 2022, Veolia and Elabe launched the first ecological transformation survey to fuel a constructive and proactive debate with its stakeholders on the acceptability of changes necessary to face the environmental emergency. This unprecedented opinion poll covered 25 countries across five continents and a sample of almost half the human population. The survey, published every 18 months, therefore assesses local and global acceptability of existing ecological solutions and identifies the obstacles and levers in implementing these solutions. The challenge: push forward the debate and better understand how ecological transformation can be achieved.

NET PROMOTER SCORE (NPS)

Veolia has developed a unique program called "Voice of customers" to measure customer satisfaction and monitor the commercial performance of all the Group's BUs. The Group uses the calculation of the Net Promoter score indicator, which measures customer satisfaction by submitting a simple survey to customers, then incorporates the obtained responses into a formula that generates a single figure - the Net Promoter Score indicator - for benchmarking purposes. Thanks to this NPS program, Veolia can listen to customers, assess its commercial performance and implement action plans to better meet their expectations.

ACADEMIC PARTNERSHIPS

In 2022, the Group signed agreements, notably with Telecom Paris as a sponsor of the 2025-year group, and ENSAM École Nationale des Arts et Métiers, which trains high-level operational engineers, through a specific commitment to the Paris, Aix-en-Provence, Lille and Bordeaux campuses. In 2023, Veolia also renewed its membership with the National Association of Research and Technology (ANRT) to discuss with other industrialists, start-ups and other R&I ecosystems all aspects of ecological transformation.

CSR ISSUE MATERIALITY ANALYSIS

In 2020, Veolia updated the materiality analysis of its CSR issues. This was an opportunity for the Group to assess the perception, by its external and internal stakeholders, of the decisions taken by the Group with regard to its purpose. This was the first step of renewed reflection that continued into 2021 on the organization of the Group's stakeholder relations strategy, under the banner "Resourcing Together".

To conduct the analysis, 24 CSR issues were identified based on a documentary study of data taken from several databases, taking into account the multifaceted performance indicators defined under the Impact 2023 strategic plan.

They were then assessed by 188 internal and external stakeholders (customers, suppliers, competitors, associations and NGOs, local residents, end consumers, regulatory authorities, etc.) during an online consultation organized from April to November 2020 by the firm Des Enjeux et des Hommes in eight Veolia Business Units: Water France, Germany, UK, Czech Republic, China, Australia / New Zealand, USA, Colombia.

The Africa – Middle East region was included in the overall results based on consultations held between 2017 and 2019 by the firm BL Évolution.

A selection of "corporate" stakeholders and head office employees were also consulted. Internal stakeholders were asked to assess the impact of CSR issues on Veolia's activity, while external stakeholders commented on their expectation in relation to the Group. To complete this analysis, 75 interviews were held with voluntary stakeholders, some of whom answered the questionnaire. These interviews were organized to discuss the risks and opportunities associated with the CSR issues, and to strengthen dialogue with stakeholders.

In this survey, the 10 most significant issues were identified worldwide, analyzed by country and stakeholder category.

Materiality matrix of Veolia CSR issues

KEY FIGURES

315 stakeholders canvassed
188 responses to the online survey
75 interviews held

The 10 most significant challenges for Veolia's external and internal stakeholders

- Security of facilities and services provided to consumers
- Quality of essential services, customer and consumer satisfaction
- Employee health and safety
- Sustainable management of resources (water, energy, waste)
- Management of pollution of resources (water, energy, waste)
- Business ethics
- Innovation for sustainable solutions
- Responsible corporate governance
- Combating climate change
- Promoting the circular economy



OUR COMMERCIAL
PERFORMANCE

OUR ENVIRONMENTAL
PERFORMANCE

OUR HUMAN
RESSOURCES
PERFORMANCE

OUR ECONOMIC AND
FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE

OUR SOCIAL
PERFORMANCE

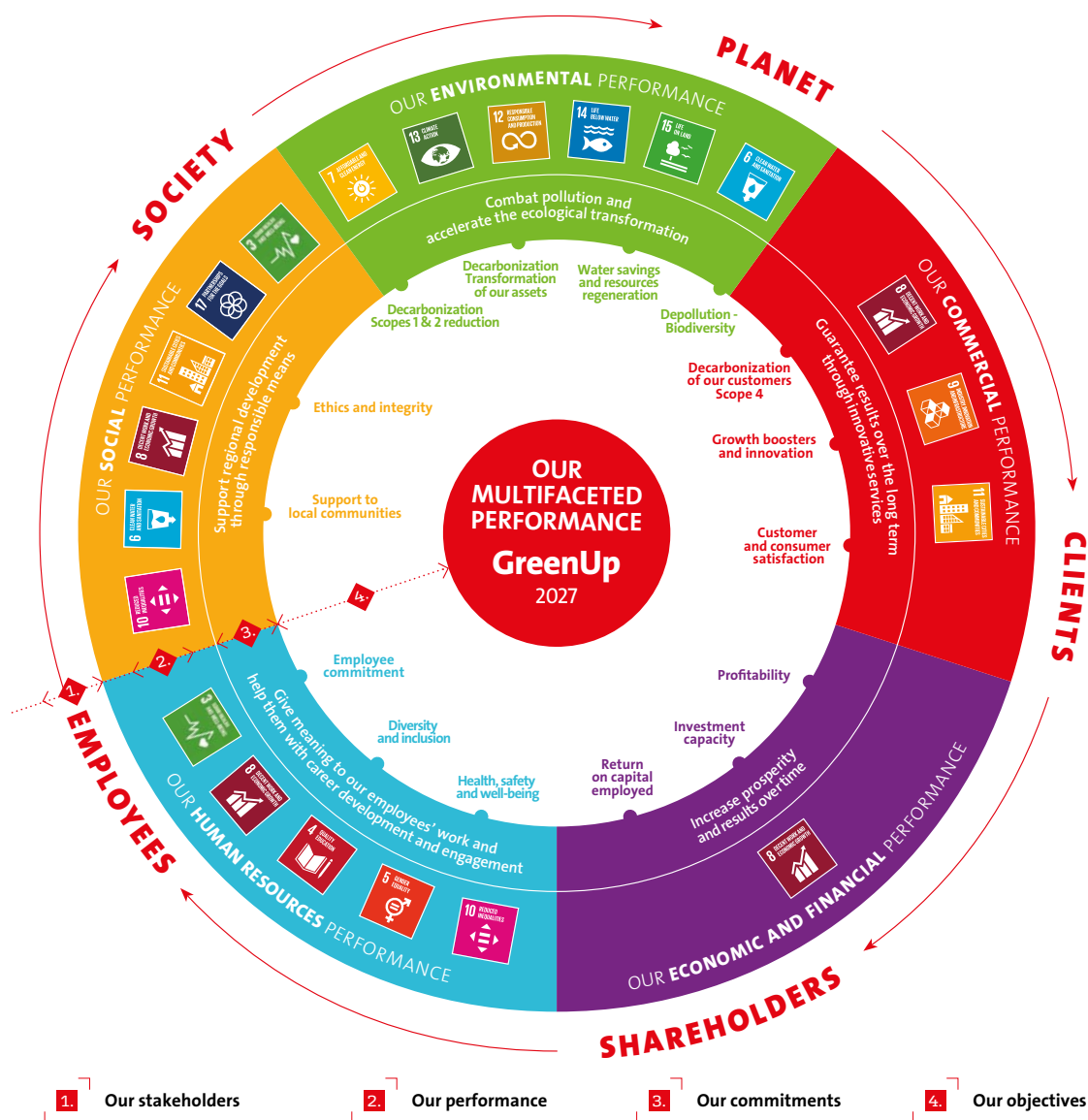
Multifaceted performance

To implement its purpose, Veolia adopted in 2020 a tool for in-depth transformation: multifaceted performance.

Multifaceted performance reconciles corporate social responsibility, with its human resources, social and environmental dimensions, with Veolia's financial and commercial challenges by paying the same level of attention to each of these dimensions to ensure a maximum sustainable impact and to be useful to all of its stakeholders (five main categories being employees, customers, shareholders, society and the planet).

This is a tool that guides the management of the Group's activities in a search for balance between 5 performance dimensions: economic and financial, commercial, human resources, social and environmental.

The Group is committed to multifaceted performance organized, in its GreenUp strategic program for 2027, around 15 progress objectives. Each of the indicators associated with the objectives is measured and audited by independent bodies to monitor progress. In particular, these indicators are used to calculate the variable compensation of Veolia's senior executives. This requirement is applied to all the Group's processes, so that the management of all its activities is guided by these multifaceted performance objectives.



With respect to the **social performance of Veolia**, Veolia aims to offer all its employees the social guarantees to protect them against life's risks and the year 2023 was marked by the deployment of **Veolia Cares**, initiated by Chief Executive Officer, Estelle Brachlianoff. Veolia Cares is a comprehensive employee benefits program that is exceptional in its avant-garde nature and scope.

Launched in 2022, it has been fully deployed in all our geographies since September 1, 2023. Veolia Cares is based on five pillars:

- **parental leave**: basic salary maintained over 10 weeks for the first parent, and over 1 week for the second parent. This measure can also be used in the event of adoption;
- **death cover**: capital equivalent to at least six months of salary is paid to beneficiaries, whatever the cause of death;
- **health cover**: guaranteed access to medical care for all our employees, whatever the local organizational methods (legal life insurance and corporate schemes);
- **support for our employee carers**: all employees carers are given the necessary flexibility in the organization of working time;
- **community charity work**: possibility for each employee to devote one paid day-off per year to a charity or environmental protection organization in line with Group values.

Veolia Cares applies to all Group employees, without gender discrimination, and whatever their status from the first day of recruitment.

Under the new GreenUp program, in terms of **human resources performance**, Veolia is committed to giving meaning to its employees' work and helping them with career development and engagement. With that objective regarding "Health, safety and well-being", Veolia has ambitious indicators on "Lost time injury frequency rate" and Employee commitment which is measured through a **Voice of Resources Survey**, and regarding its objective of "Diversity and inclusion", Veolia ambitioned to **increase the proportion of women in the Group Management Committee**.

And, in terms of social performance, regarding local communities, Veolia is committed to support regional development through responsible means. With an objective of "Ethics and integrity", Veolia measures positive answers to the ethics and compliance question in the Voice of Resources survey and with an objective of providing support to local communities, Veolia ambitioned to increase the number of residents benefiting from inclusive solutions to access essential services (all activities).

Veolia is also committed to preserving biodiversity.

With the aim at depolluting and thus improving health and protecting biodiversity, the goals of Veolia are:

- **to increase our positive impacts**:
 - on reducing the carbon footprint of municipal and industrial activities;
 - limiting pollutant discharge into water by sanitation processes;
 - limiting the environmental impacts of discharges into the air, water and soil;
 - increasing the circularity of resources (water and waste); and optimizing land-use conditions.
- **to reduce the negative impacts of Veolia's and its customers' activities**: Veolia's goals are to limit atmospheric pollutants – SO_x, NO_x, dust, etc. – from thermal installations producing over 100 GWh per year and waste incinerators;
- **to take increased account of protection for environments and biodiversity in our Group standard, and in particular, limit our sites' impacts; to raise awareness** as much as possible both internally and externally, and **to boost stakeholder engagement** with our undertaking to protect environments and biodiversity.

In terms of actions for **environmental performance**, in 2019, the Group inventoried its sensitive sites with regard to protecting environments and biodiversity and, with the mobilization of all the Business Units, the scope improved since. Veolia commits to the **objective of "Protection of environments and biodiversity"** and measures its progress on action plans regarding Biodiversity preservation on sensitive sites with a target of more than 85% of the sites. Veolia commits also to ambitious objectives for 2027: **95% of sites with "zero" use of phytosanitary products; 95% implementation rate of ecological management at sites with more than one hectare of greenspaces and 100% of traceability of biomass (wood) for energy production** and of biomass (wood) certification for energy production.

Veolia has also developed solutions for **reducing human pressure on biodiversity** and protecting the environment:

- Sanitation services for almost 97 million people worldwide and 3,506 urban wastewater treatment plans in operation;
- Solutions for ecological restoration and remediation of soil;
- Water supply protection solutions;
- Solutions for a smaller environmental footprint and Treatment of waste, including hazardous waste.

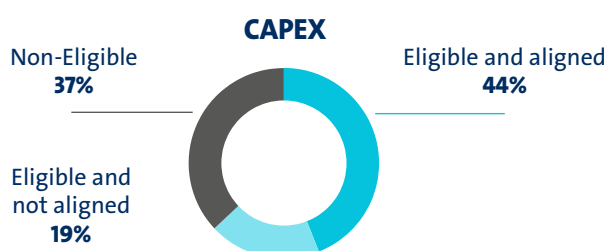
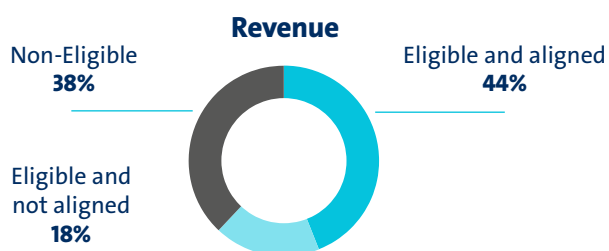
Veolia also dedicates resources and innovates for the preservation of biodiversity and the prevention of environmental risks. For instance, Veolia has developed an **environmental footprint tool for offerings and contracts, GreenPath**, which is a web platform used by sales and technical teams to compare the environmental footprints of several solutions and choose, with customers, the solution that best meets their performance objectives. The tool calculates the **carbon footprint** of new projects and existing contracts in accordance with ISO 14064 and ISO 14069 and their **water footprint** in accordance with ISO 14046 and assesses their **impact on biodiversity**. It is available on the Group's intranet and covers Veolia's three business lines: Water, Waste and Energy.

1.4 GOVERNANCE, ETHICS AND COMPLIANCE

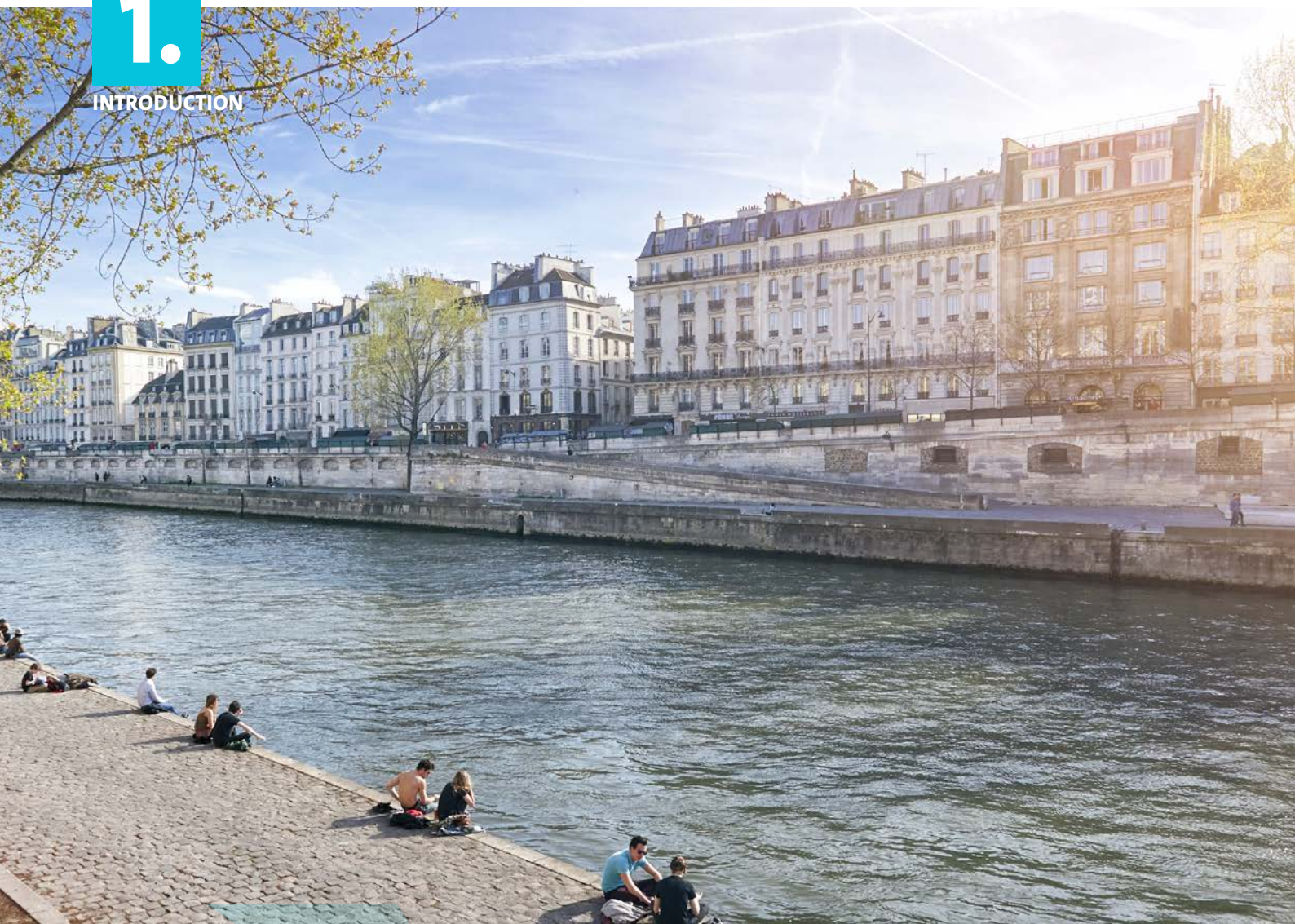
Veolia is the winner of the Sustainable Governance Award, at the 2023 edition of AGEFI's Sustainable Business & Finance Awards. Veolia's strong business performance is underpinned by a robust governance process and transparent reporting. The Group achieved this through the implementation of various conduct policies, rules, and guidelines. Further details on the management of ethics and compliance are in chapter 2.2 of this Green Financing Framework.

1.5 EU TAXONOMY

In its 2024 Universal Registration Document (URD),¹ Veolia has reported the share of revenue, capital expenditure and operational expenditure eligible and aligned, eligible but not aligned, and non-eligible to the EU Taxonomy, with details on the calculation methodologies. Veolia has identified that its activities correspond to 47 different economic activities covered by the EU Taxonomy, corresponding to all environmental objectives (except for biodiversity). All details on the methodologies to assess Taxonomy alignment are described in section 4.1.2.6 of Veolia's URD.



1. <https://www.veolia.com/en/media/93276>



1.6 SUPPORTING THE UN SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

Between 2000 and 2015, Veolia was a major contributor to the **United Nations Millennium Development Goals (MDGs)** for access to water and wastewater services. It remains an active player in ensuring that the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) adopted in 2015 are attained.

As such, the Veolia Foundation supported the creation of a **MOOC (Massive Open Online Course)** dedicated to the SDGs. Launched in 2018 by the Virtual Environment and Development University (VED), it presents the 17 SDGs and how they interact with each other. Overall, nearly 25,000 people have familiarized themselves with these global requirements. The SDG MOOC has been translated into five languages and won the “Best MOOC developed by a university or school” prize at the MOOC of the Year awards.

Veolia participates in the implementation of each of the 17 sustainable development goals of the United Nations, with a direct impact on 14 of them



1.7 EXTERNAL RECOGNITION

Veolia's non-financial performance is rated externally based on published information and statements. This rating is valuable, as it is an independent measure of the Group's performance and allows it to remain attentive to expert opinion.

	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
DJSI, renamed Dow Jones Best-in-class indices	Inclusion in World and Europe DJSI indices	Inclusion in World and Europe DJSI indices	Inclusion in World and Europe DJSI indices	Inclusion in World and Europe DJSI indices	Inclusion in World and Europe DJSI indices
FTSE4Good	Inclusion	Inclusion	Inclusion	Inclusion	Inclusion
S&P Global	82 (Silver)	82 (Bronze)	83 (Bronze)	83 1st in Multi and Water Utilities	79 2nd in Multi and Water Utilities
ISS-ESG	Prime, 1 st decile, B	Prime, 1 st decile, B	Prime, 1 st decile, B-	Prime, 1 st decile, B	Prime, 1 st decile, B
Moody's Analytics	68/100	71/100	71/100	72/100	73/100 (sector average = 53/100)
CDP Climate change	Leadership, A-	Management, B	Leadership, A	Leadership, A-	Leadership, A
CDP Water security	Leadership, A-	Leadership, A-	Leadership, A-	Leadership, A-	Leadership, A-
EcoVadis	70/100 98th percentile	68/100 95th percentile	75/100 98th percentile	-/-	68/100 89th percentile

A few months after the launch of its new strategic GreenUp program, which plans to accelerate its decarbonization trajectory, Veolia has taken a significant new step in its climate strategy by obtaining the **validation of its objectives by the Science Based Targets initiatives (SBTi)**, the international reference in this field. The SBTi notably praised the Group's net-zero ambition, recognized as the most ambitious among those it tracks.

Furthermore, the international rating agency **Moody's** also analyzed and recognized the quality of Veolia's transition plan in its Net Zero Assessment, awarding Veolia an **overall score of NZ-2** (on a scale of NZ-1 to NZ-5), and praising the ambition and solidity of its short-term implementation. This is based in particular on the use of proven technologies by the Group and a higher than average return on transition investments.

Veolia thus became **the first company to obtain double validation of its climate commitments by two leading international organizations.**

1.8 RATIONALE FOR GREEN FINANCING INSTRUMENTS ISSUANCE

With its newly published GreenUp strategy, Veolia has the ambition to be a leader in providing solutions for the ecological transformation. This new strategic program aims to accelerate the deployment of affordable, replicable solutions that depollute, decarbonize and regenerate our resources. To support its investments, Veolia has the ambition to equip itself with a state-of-the-art Green Financing Framework, to reflect its sustainable commitments in its financing strategy.

2.

VEOLIA'S GREEN FINANCING FRAMEWORK

Under this Green Financing Framework, Veolia can issue financing instruments in the form of bonds ("**Green Bonds**"), loans ("**Green Loans**") and other financing instruments, the net proceeds of which are earmarked to, and used to finance, Eligible Projects as defined in section 2.1 Use of Proceeds, below (the "**Green Financing Instruments**").

Veolia may notably issue **Blue financing instruments**, such as **Blue Bonds** or **Blue Loans**, which are a subset of Green Financing Instruments where the proceeds are exclusively allocated to water-related expenditures identified in the Eligible Project Category "Water" in the table below ("**Blue Financing Instruments**").

For an issuance in bond format, the Green Financing Framework is compliant with the Green Bond Principles² ("**GBP**") as published in June 2021 (with June 2022 Appendix 1), administered by the International Capital Market Association ("**ICMA**").

For issuance in loan format, the Green Financing Framework is aligned with the Green Loan Principles³ ("**GLP**") published in February 2023, administered by the Loan Market Association ("**LMA**"), Loan Syndications and Trading Association ("**LSTA**") and Asia Pacific Loan Market Association ("**APLMA**").

To enable the issuance of Blue Financing Instruments, the Green Financing Framework also takes into consideration the Guidelines for Blue Finance⁴ from the International Finance Corporation (in its January 2022 version) and the "Bonds to Finance the Sustainable Blue Economy (SBE) – A Practitioner's Guide" (September 2023)⁵.

The Green Financing Framework also follows the key recommendations of the ICMA and LMA principles with regards to External Reviews.

2. [ICMA Green Bond Principles \(GBP\) 2021](#) (with June 2022 Appendix 1). The possible types of Green Bonds to be issued against the framework are as defined in Appendix 1, with the associated disclosure requirements for covered bonds to be followed if relevant.

3. [LMA Green Loan Principles \(GLP\) 2023](#)

4. [International Finance Corporation Guidelines for Blue Finance](#)

5. [Bonds to Finance the Sustainable Blue Economy](#) - collaboration between Asian Development Bank (ADB), ICMA, International Finance Corporation (IFC), United Nations Environment Programme – Finance Initiative (UNEP FI), and United Nations Global Compact (UNGC)



The Green Financing Framework adopts the four core components of the GBP and GLP, which include:

1. Use of Proceeds
2. Process for Project Evaluation and Selection
3. Management of Proceeds
4. Reporting.

2.1 USE OF PROCEEDS

An amount equivalent to the net proceeds from Veolia's Green Financing Instruments will be used to finance and/or re-finance, in whole or in part, one or more of the projects included in the Eligible Projects which are projects providing environmental benefits and which:

(i) comply with the Eligibility Criteria described below; and
(ii) are limited to those projects that occurred in the two (2) calendar years prior to issuance (the look-back period), the current calendar year, and the two (2) calendar years following issuance (the look-forward period).

Recognising the importance of a common definition of sustainable activities, the Green Financing Framework takes into consideration the EU Taxonomy Delegated Acts⁸ on all EU environmental objectives.

Types of Eligible Expenditures

Green Financing Instruments can finance **Eligible Expenditures** which are:

- Capital expenditures ("CapEx") meeting the Eligibility Criteria described below;
- or
- Equity investments for the acquisition of a controlling stake⁶ in "pure player"⁷ entities following the Eligibility Criteria described below.

Eligibility Criteria

The Eligible Projects financed and/or refinanced under this Green Financing Framework:

- **all contribute to at least one of the EU environmental objectives⁹;**
- and
- **all satisfy the EU Taxonomy's Substantial Contribution Criteria and the Minimum Safeguards** (see section 2.2 Process for Project Evaluation and Selection for further details) as indicated in the table matrix below, the "**Eligibility Criteria**".

Eligible Projects are classified under each ICMA GBP / LMA GLP category, each, "Eligible Project Category", and, as the case may be, "Eligible Sub-Category".

The following acronyms are used to refer to the economic activities as defined in the EU Taxonomy Delegated Acts for each environmental objective:

CCM – substantial contribution to Climate Change Mitigation
CE – substantial contribution to the Circular Economy
PPC – substantial contribution to Pollution Prevention and Control

6. Exclusive or joint control on the acquired company, in which case Veolia establishes oversight of the acquired company and its assets. In the case of joint control, only Veolia's share in the acquisition will be taken into account for allocation purposes.

7. Companies having at least 90% of revenue, or if not applicable 90% of the balance sheet, derived from Eligible Project Categories described in the Green Financing Framework. Shares of these entities are not publicly traded.

8. All Delegated acts can be found [here](#)

9. The six EU environmental objectives are: Climate change mitigation, Climate change adaptation, sustainable use and protection of water resources, transition to a circular economy, pollution prevention and control, and protection and restoration of biodiversity and ecosystems. Key points of the Taxonomy Regulation can be found [here](#)

Eligible
Project
Category

ENERGY

ICMA GBP / LMA GLP category: **Energy Efficiency, Renewable Energy**

Eligible Sub-Category	Eligibility Criteria – Substantial Contribution Criteria for the associated EU Taxonomy Economic Activity	Description and Example Activities	EU Environmental Objectives and UN SDGs	Examples of Results and Impact Indicators
Production of heat/cool and district heating/cooling distribution	CCM 4.15 District heating/cooling distribution CCM 4.20 Cogeneration of heat/cool and power from bioenergy CCM 4.24 Production of heat/cool from bioenergy CCM 4.25 Production of heat/cool using waste heat	District heating/cooling: Construction, refurbishment and operation of pipelines and associated infrastructure for distribution of heating and cooling Construction and operation of facilities that produce heat/cool from bioenergy or waste heat. Example projects: - in Hungary, Kecskemét biomasse power plant - in Belgium, Bella Vita heat production and delivery for an urban district - Poznan waste heat from car factory	Climate Change Mitigation  	• Energy generated (thermal and electrical) • Share of renewable and recovered energy generated • Greenhouse gas emission savings from the use of biomass
Electricity generation from bioenergy	CCM 4.8 Electricity generation from bioenergy	Construction and operation of electricity generation installations that produce electricity exclusively from Biomass (including the biogenic fraction of municipal waste to be incinerated), biogas or bioliquids, excluding electricity generation from blending of renewable fuels with biogas or bioliquids. Sourcing criteria: Agricultural biomass used and forest biomass used in the activity complies with the criteria laid down in relevant paragraphs of Directive (EU) 2018/2001. Example projects: - In Hungary, Pécs biomass renewable energy - In Germany, Sames WSM project	Climate Change Mitigation 	• Greenhouse gas emission savings from the use of biomass • Energy generated (thermal and electrical)
Transmission and distribution of electricity	CCM 4.9 Transmission and distribution of electricity	Construction and operation of transmission and distribution systems that transport electricity. Example projects: - In Belgium, Flexcity , a leading actor of electric flexibility services	Climate Change Mitigation 	• Newly enabled generation capacity in the system • Average system grid emissions factor • GHG emissions avoided/reduced
Solar Photovoltaic electricity production	CCM 4.1 Solar Photovoltaic electricity production	Installation and maintenance of solar photovoltaic (PV) panels. This activity is to be used for installations dedicated to PV electricity generation, such as PV farms on landfills or WWTP.	Climate Change Mitigation  	• Solar PV installed capacity • GHG emissions avoided • Generation of electricity using solar PV technology

2.

VEOLIA'S GREEN FINANCING FRAMEWORK

Eligible
Project
Category



WATER

Eligible for Blue Financing Instruments

ICMA SBE Guide category: **Marine Pollution / IFC Blue Guidelines – Water supply**
ICMA GBP / LMA GLP category: **Sustainable water and wastewater management**

Eligible Sub-Category	Eligibility Criteria – Substantial Contribution Criteria for the associated EU Taxonomy Economic Activity	Description and Example Activities	EU Environmental Objectives and UN SDGs	Examples of Results and Impact Indicators
Freshwater supply	CCM 5.1 Construction, extension and operation of water collection, treatment and supply systems	Activities of water abstraction and/or treatment plant and/or drinking water distribution and/or production of industrial water Example projects: - Honolulu water reclamation plant - Kuala Lumpur TRX Water reuse scheme - in Romania, Apa Nova Bucharest	Climate Change Mitigation Sustainable use and protection of water and marine resources  	- Amount of drinking water produced and distributed - Energy efficiency of drinking water production (excluding seawater desalination) (pro forma 2019-2023) - Net average energy consumption for abstraction and treatment
Wastewater treatment	CCM 5.3 Construction, extension and operation of wastewater collection and treatment	Activities of sewer networks and/or wastewater treatment plants. Example projects: - Asahiko Wastewater treatment plant	Sustainable use and protection of water and marine resources 	- Energy efficiency of wastewater treatment: Net energy consumption of the wastewater treatment plant - Volume of water reused from collected and treated wastewater - Wastewater treatment sludge recovery rate

2.

VEOLIA'S GREEN FINANCING FRAMEWORK

Eligible
Project
Category



WASTE

ICMA GBP / LMA GLP category: **Pollution Prevention and Control, Circular economy adapted products, production technologies and processes**

Eligible Sub-Category	Eligibility Criteria – Substantial Contribution Criteria for the associated EU Taxonomy Economic Activity	Description and Example Activities	EU Environmental Objectives and UN SDGs	Examples of Results and Impact Indicators
Collection and transport of waste	CCM 5.5 Collection and transport of non-hazardous waste in source segregated fractions CE 2.3 Collection and transport of non-hazardous and hazardous waste	Waste collection services for all types of client (municipal, commercial, or industrial), for non-hazardous waste in single or comingled fractions aimed at preparing for reuse or recycling. Where financing is directed towards collection vehicles, these will be limited to those that are either fully electric or powered by LNG or gas-to-liquids (GTL). Example projects: - In France, BU RVD, 'Collection and Collection Center of municipal clients' - Esterra	Climate Change Mitigation Circular Economy Pollution Prevention and Control  	- Quantity of municipal and industrial waste collected (t) - Number of financed collection vehicles (and types of vehicles) - Type of financed waste storage
	PPC 2.1 Collection and transport of hazardous waste	Separate collection and transport of hazardous waste prior to treatment, material recovery or disposal. Example projects: - In Europe, activities from SARPI, the European leader for the treatment and recovery of hazardous waste and polluted sites	 	Amount of hazardous waste collected/treated
Non hazardous waste management	CCM 5.9 Material recovery from non-hazardous waste CE 2.7 Sorting and material recovery of non-hazardous waste	Construction and operation of facilities for the sorting and processing of separately collected non-hazardous waste streams into secondary raw materials involving mechanical reprocessing, except for backfilling purpose Example projects: - In Poland, Veolia EKOZEC , a specialist of Combustion by-Products management, which is active on Total Waste Management.	Climate Change Mitigation Circular Economy Pollution Prevention and Control	- Volume of treated waste - Volume of plastics recycled in Veolia's processing plants - Material recovery rate from treated waste
	CCM 5.8 Composting of separately collected bio-waste	Construction and operation of dedicated facilities for the treatment of separately collected bio-waste through composting (aerobic digestion) with the resulting production and utilisation of compost. Example projects: - In France, project of Veolia Agriculture France: Sede-Compostage: Compostage Interne	 	Amount of waste composted
	CCM 5.10 Landfill gas capture and utilization	Installation and operation of infrastructure for landfill gas capture and utilisation in permanently closed landfills or landfill cells using new or supplementary dedicated technical facilities and equipment installed during or post landfill or landfill cell closure. Minimum gas recovery of 70% Example projects: - In France, " Val'Pôles " of Claye-Souilly and Plessis-Gassot, industrial ecology sites that, amongst other activities, produce renewable energy coming from waste biogas.	 	Amount of gas captured

2.

VEOLIA'S GREEN FINANCING FRAMEWORK

Eligible
Project
Category



WASTE

ICMA GBP / LMA GLP category: **Pollution Prevention and Control, Circular economy adapted products, production technologies and processes**

Eligible Sub-Category	Eligibility Criteria – Substantial Contribution Criteria for the associated EU Taxonomy Economic Activity	Description and Example Activities	EU Environmental Objectives and UN SDGs	Examples of Results and Impact Indicators
Hazardous waste management	CE 2.4 Treatment of hazardous waste PPC 2.2 Treatment of hazardous waste	Construction, repurposing, upgrade, and operation of dedicated facilities for the treatment of hazardous waste, including as a means for material recovery operations Example projects: - In the UK, Garston Solvent Recycling Facility	Climate Change Mitigation Circular Economy Pollution Prevention and Control    	• Material recovery rate of secondary raw materials (including chemical substances and critical raw materials) meant to substitute primary raw materials or chemicals in production processes

EXCLUSIONS

For the avoidance of doubt, any financing related to the following activities are excluded from the Eligible Projects:

- Projects linked to nuclear activities (such as nuclear power plants and related infrastructures);
- Projects related to acquisition, development, operation and maintenance of new or existing fossil fuel-based electricity generation capacity or heating systems (including, but not limited to, coal, oil or natural gas-powered projects);
- Projects in the oil & gas value chain (for example, water treatment in refinery processes) and
- In the specific context of transmission and distribution infrastructure: projects for infrastructure dedicated to directly and solely connecting or expanding existing direct connection to production plants that are fossil-fuel based.

2.2 PROCESS FOR PROJECT EVALUATION AND SELECTION

Veolia's ESG Committee is responsible for the overall governance of the Green Financing Framework and for the selection and monitoring of the Eligible Projects.

The **ESG Committee** is co-chaired by the Group General Counsel, the Senior Executive Vice President for Strategy and Innovation and the Senior Executive Vice President for Human Resources. It brings together functional departments in charge of environmental, social, societal, compliance and governance matters and ensures their coordination. It defines Veolia's strategic priorities and approves its environmental policy, objectives and management system. It also includes the Head of Sustainable Finance and Head of Sustainability. The committee will discuss sustainable finance topics twice a year, and as required for specific issuances.

ROLE OF THE ESG COMMITTEE

The ESG Committee is the oversight mechanism for:

- Reviewing, selecting and validating the Eligible Projects:
 - The Eligible Projects are identified and tracked through the internal IT systems as those eligible or aligned to the EU Taxonomy, following Veolia's internal protocol;
 - The Committee will further screen and assess that the Eligible Projects meet the Eligibility Criteria, as well as Veolia's Sustainability Policies and Procedures;
- Annually reviewing the list of Eligible Projects against the Eligibility Criteria and exclusionary criteria. If a project no longer meets the Eligibility Criteria, the Eligible Project will be removed from the register and replaced as soon as a substitute has been identified;
- Monitoring any material ESG risk or controversy impacting the financed Eligible Projects;
- Validating the proceeds allocation;
- Overseeing, approving and publishing the Allocation Report and the Impact Report, including external assurance statements;
- Monitoring the on-going market evolution, particularly in relation to disclosure and reporting, to ensure Veolia is in-line with market practices.

IDENTIFICATION AND MITIGATION OF ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL RISKS

In accordance with Law no. 2017-399 of 27 March 2017 relating to the duty of care obligations of parent companies and contractors, Veolia publishes each year a "vigilance plan" setting out how the Group complies with the requirements of this legislation. This vigilance plan is available on the website of Veolia.¹⁰

In addition to ensuring that Eligible Projects meet applicable national and international environmental and social standards and regulations, Veolia has put in place a strong evaluation and selection process, that leverages its existing sustainability and risk management framework to ensure the mitigation of potential environmental and social risks associated with the Eligible Projects, as described below.

A Group alert procedure is in place which consists in a system for promptly informing Veolia's management bodies, specifically General Management, of any events or situations faced by the operational or functional entities. Under this procedure, significant environmental damage is considered to be serious by its very nature and is bound to trigger the Group alert.

Environmental and social risks related to Eligible Projects are identified and managed at corporate level, including the Minimum Safeguards.

10. For 2023: <https://www.veolia.com/sites/g/files/dvc4206/files/document/2024/06/veolia-vigilance-plan-2023.pdf>

MANAGEMENT OF HUMAN RIGHTS

- Human rights policy based on eight priority issues;
- Mapping of human rights risks, assessed by a third party;
- Participant since 2003 in the United Nations Global Compact.

MANAGEMENT OF ENVIRONMENTAL RISKS

The executing Environmental & Industrial Management System (EIMS) has a unified list of environmental and industrial risks as well as risk management resources (essentials, standards and internal Group best practices). It covers all of the Group's activities (and includes its main joint ventures). The EIMS allows the Group to measure its environmental and industrial impacts, with the ultimate goal of reducing them, in accordance with its commitments; makes it possible to control the risks and opportunities relating to the environment and provides a framework that helps the Group to achieve its environmental objectives based on a review and annual assessment of its environmental performance; and is based on a continuous improvement approach in which the BUs and their managers play a key role.

MANAGEMENT OF GOVERNANCE RISKS

Veolia has an Ethics guide, published on its website in 24 languages and available on its intranet for all employees. It includes in the annex the "Anti-Corruption Code of Conduct". Internal awareness-raising initiatives are organized by the Group's Compliance Department to ensure that the principles set out in these documents are upheld. Training programs covering compliance with competition law, the prevention of criminal risk and awareness of the risk of corruption have been rolled out in all the regions in which Veolia operates.

MANAGEMENT OF ETHICS AND COMPLIANCE

- Implementation of an Ethics Guide, Ethics Committee, and a Group Ethics Alert tool;
- Any employee can alert the Ethics Committee (using a whistleblowing system);
- Enhance compliance with support from the Compliance Department, reporting to the Group General Counsel, and a network of officers covering the whole Group, reporting operationally to the Chief Compliance Officer;
- As part of the Engagement Survey in 2023, out of approximately 160,000 employees surveyed, 88% gave a positive answer when asked whether Veolia's values and ethics are applied in their respective entities, the highest level since 2020.

MANAGEMENT OF CORRUPTION, ANTI-COMPETITIVE PRACTICES, AND FRAUD

- Measures aimed at meeting the highest international standards and the principles and recommendations of international bodies such as the OECD, World Bank, United Nations, and Transparency International;
- Adoption of an anti-corruption code of conduct by the Executive Committee in 2018;
- Programs to prevent corruption, anti-competitive practices, and fraud: in 2023, 36,200 Veolia employees attended mandatory e-learning courses;
- Implementation, based on business specific risks, of a tool to assess suppliers, major customers, and other particularly sensitive third parties such as brokers or partners involved in the Group's development project.

DATA PROTECTION AND CYBERSECURITY

- Organization to ensure the application of national and European regulations relating to processing an individual's personal data (GDPR);
- Establishment since 2013 of an organization responsible for information systems security, along with a special crisis cell, e-learning courses, and some entities gaining ISO 27001, NIST, or equivalent certification.

EU TAXONOMY MINIMUM SAFEGUARDS

Veolia considers that it satisfies the minimum safeguards in 2024 and will undergo this assessment for each annual reporting.¹² The minimum safeguards requirements were analysed as follows:

- Human rights and workers' rights in accordance with the OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises and the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, and Fair competition, bribery and corruption: Veolia has pre-existing compliance, risk and human resources management systems, as set in this current section of this document, and in the absence of significant breaches, in line with the French "duty of care" regulation¹³;
- Taxation: it is closely monitored at head office level by the Veolia Finance Department to ensure compliance with regulations and the absence of any major tax conflicts.

Veolia has set up due diligence and mitigation measures, using a risk-based approach. They will be extended to the value chain in line with the deployment of the CSRD, with two years to adapt the new reporting requirements (i.e. FY-2026 closing at the latest).

11. <https://www.veolia.com/en/veolia-group/who-are-we/ethics-and-values>

12. As detailed in Chapter 4 of its 2024 URD

13. LOI n° 2017-399 du 27 mars 2017 relative au devoir de vigilance des sociétés mères et des entreprises donneuses d'ordre
<https://www.legifrance.gouv.fr/jorf/id/JORFTEXT000034290626/>

VALUE CHAIN

Veolia's responsible purchasing policy includes requirements in terms of environmental protection, applicable to suppliers and subcontractors.

In 2021, Veolia's Purchasing Department developed a new Sustainable Purchasing Program, which aims to align the purchasing strategy with the Group's Purpose and its multifaceted performance model, to comply with new regulatory and non-financial reporting requirements, control risks in the supplier chain, integrate supplier innovation through new business models by creating differentiating value for our offerings and finally, to affirm the strategic role of purchasing in ecological and social transformation, with our stakeholders.

The program is founded on four pillars relating to defining themes and a fifth cross-cutting pillar to support change management:

1. Decarbonize the supply chain;
2. Promote the circular economy;
3. Deploy the compliance program and protect human rights;
4. Create value in our territories and encourage inclusive sourcing;
5. Support and accompany our buyers and partners.

More details can be found in Chapter 4 of the 2024 URD. The Supplier Charter is available on [Veolia's website](#).¹⁴

2.3 MANAGEMENT OF PROCEEDS

Veolia's Treasury team will manage the allocation of an amount equivalent to the net proceeds of its Green Financing Instrument on an aggregated basis for multiple Green Financing Instruments (portfolio approach). To manage this process, Veolia will integrate information on the Green Financing Instruments in its EU Taxonomy database, so it can serve as its Green Financing Register, centralizing all the relevant information, which will be reviewed semi-annually by Veolia's Treasury team.

If any allocated Eligible Projects are removed from the Green Financing Register, Veolia will strive to substitute those projects with replacement Eligible Project(s). Replacement of the Eligible Project(s) will be done on a best effort basis, as soon as possible and within a reasonable period of 24 months.

Pending full allocation of an amount equal to the net proceeds of outstanding Green Financing Instrument, the unallocated proceeds will be held in accordance with temporary investments such as cash, cash equivalents and / or other liquid marketable investments in line with Veolia's treasury management policies.

2.4 REPORTING

For each Green Financing Instrument, Veolia commits to publish on its website an allocation report (the "**Allocation Report**") and an impact report (the "**Impact Report**"), annually, starting one year after issuance, until full allocation of the proceeds and thereafter in the event of any material changes until the relevant maturity date.

a. Allocation Reporting

Veolia's Allocation Report will provide information on the allocation of the net proceeds of its Green Financing Instruments.

The information will contain at least the following details:

- a. Net proceeds of outstanding Green Financing Instruments;
- b. Total amount of net proceeds allocated, by Eligible Project Category;
- c. Subject to confidentiality considerations, a list and/or sample of Eligible Projects financed through Veolia's Green Financing Instruments, including a description of the projects and allocated amounts;
- d. Total amount of net proceeds allocated to Eligible Projects fully aligned with the EU Taxonomy (meaning, complying with the Technical Screening Criteria (Substantial Contribution Criteria and the Do not Significant Harm (DNSH) criteria) and the Minimum Safeguards) and the amount of net proceeds allocated to Eligible Projects following only the Substantial Contribution Criteria and the Minimum Safeguards, by Eligible Project Category;
- e. The proportional allocation of proceeds between existing projects (refinancing) and new projects (financing); and
- f. The remaining balance of unallocated proceeds and nature of temporary placements (if any).

b. Impact Reporting

Veolia intends to align, on a best effort basis, with the reporting recommendations as outlined in ICMA's "[Handbook – Harmonized Framework for Impact Reporting](#)" (June 2024).

Veolia will provide impact reporting at the Eligible Project Category level, following the Impact Indicators identified and listed, for illustrative purposes, in the Use of Proceeds table in section 2.1. The exact list of Impact Indicators used will be available in the Impact Report (when such indicators are available). Veolia will also include project level information where possible for illustration purposes.

The Impact Report will include information on the methodology and assumptions used to evaluate the Eligible Projects impacts.

¹⁴. <https://www.veolia.com/sites/g/files/dvc4206/files/document/2019/07/Veolia-general-principles-suppliers-relationship-032019.pdf>



2.5 EXTERNAL REVIEW

a. Pre-Issuance External Review: Second Party Opinion (“SPO”)

Veolia has appointed Moody's to provide a Second Party Opinion on this Green Financing Framework, to confirm alignment with the GBP and GLP. The Second Party Opinion is available on the Green Bond section of Veolia's website.

Any material amendment to the Green Financing Framework will be subject to an updated Second Party Opinion.

b. Post-Issuance External Verification on Reporting

Veolia will request on an annual basis, starting one year after issuance and until full allocation, an assurance report on the allocation of the Green Financing Instrument proceeds to Eligible Projects, provided by an external auditor.

2.6 AMENDMENTS TO THE GREEN FINANCING FRAMEWORK

Veolia will review the Green Financing Framework from time to time, including its alignment to updated versions of the relevant principles as and when they are released, with the aim of adhering to best practices in the market.

Such review may result in the Green Financing Framework being updated and amended. The updates, if not minor in nature, will be subject to the prior approval of a qualified provider of Second Party Opinions. Any future updated version of the Green Financing Framework that may exist will either keep or improve the current levels of transparency and reporting disclosures. Any Green Financing Instrument will be aligned to the most recent version of the Green Financing Framework published at the time of issue of, or entry into, such Green Financing Instrument transaction. The updated Green Financing Framework, if any, will be published on Veolia's website and will replace this Green Financing Framework.

DISCLAIMER

The information and opinions contained in the Green Financing Framework (the “Document”) are provided as of the date of the Document and are subject to changes without notice. None of Veolia, or any member of the Group assume any responsibility or obligation to update or revise any such statements, regardless of whether those statements are affected by the results of new information, future events or otherwise.

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